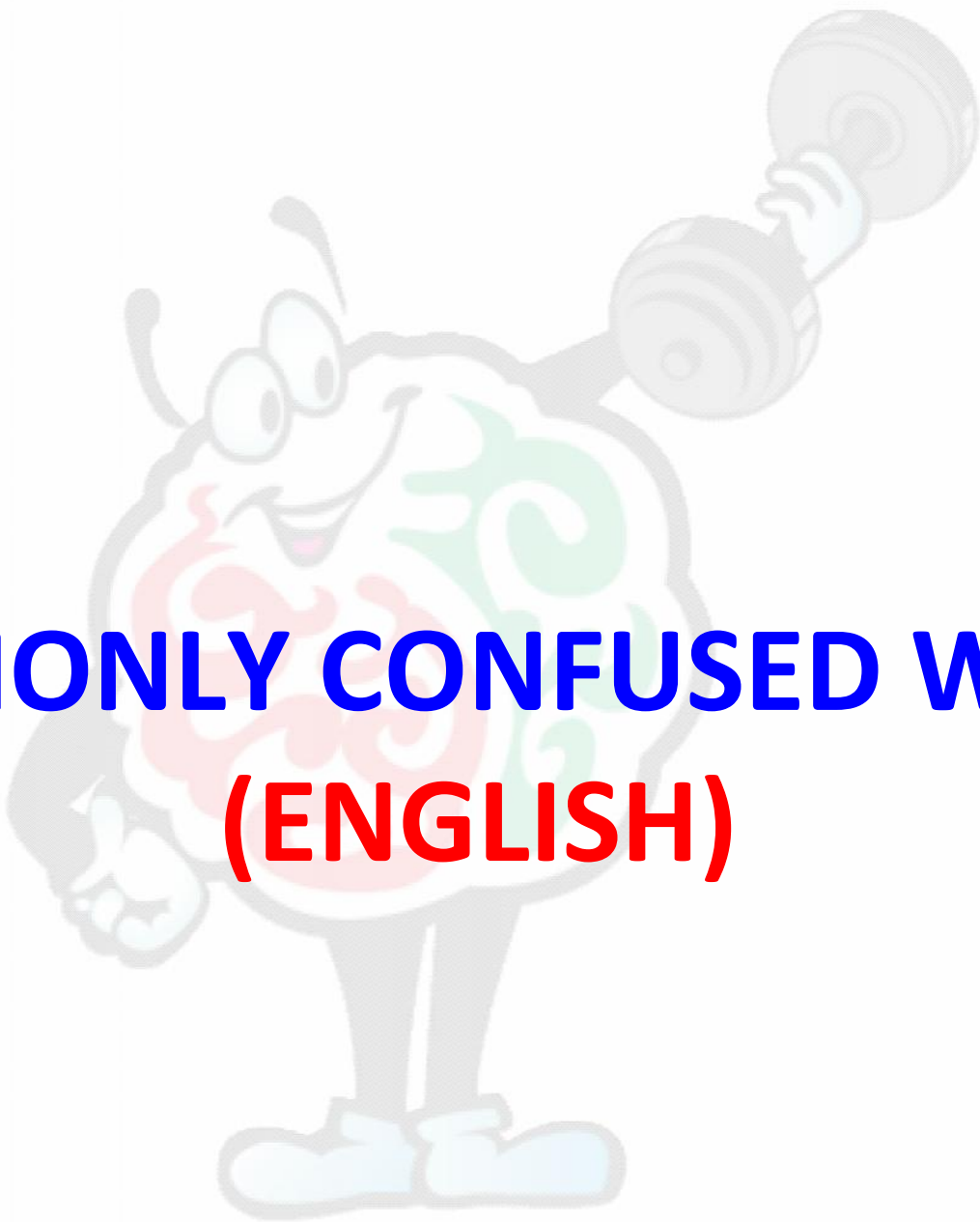




COMMONLY CONFUSED WORDS

(ENGLISH)

ACCEPT-to receive

ex: He accepts defeat well.

EXCEPT-to take or leave out

ex: Please take all the books off the shelf except for the red one.

AFFECT-to influence

ex: Lack of sleep affects the quality of your work.

EFFECT-n., result, v., to accomplish

ex: The subtle effect of the lighting made the room look ominous.

ex: Can the university effect such a change without disrupting classes?

A LOT (two words)-many.

ALOT (one word)-Not the correct form.

ALLUSION-an indirect reference

ex: The professor made an allusion to Virginia Woolf's work.

ILLUSION-a false perception of reality

ex: They saw a mirage: that is a type of illusion one sees in the desert.

ALL READY-prepared

ex: Dinner was all ready when the guests arrived.

ALREADY-by this time

ex: The turkey was already burned when the guests arrived.

ALTOGETHER-entirely

ex: Altogether, I thought that the student's presentation was well planned.

ALL TOGETHER-gathered, with everything in one place

ex: We were all together at the family reunion last spring.

APART-to be separated

ex: The chain-link fence kept the angry dogs apart. OR My old car fell apart before we reached California.

A PART-to be joined with

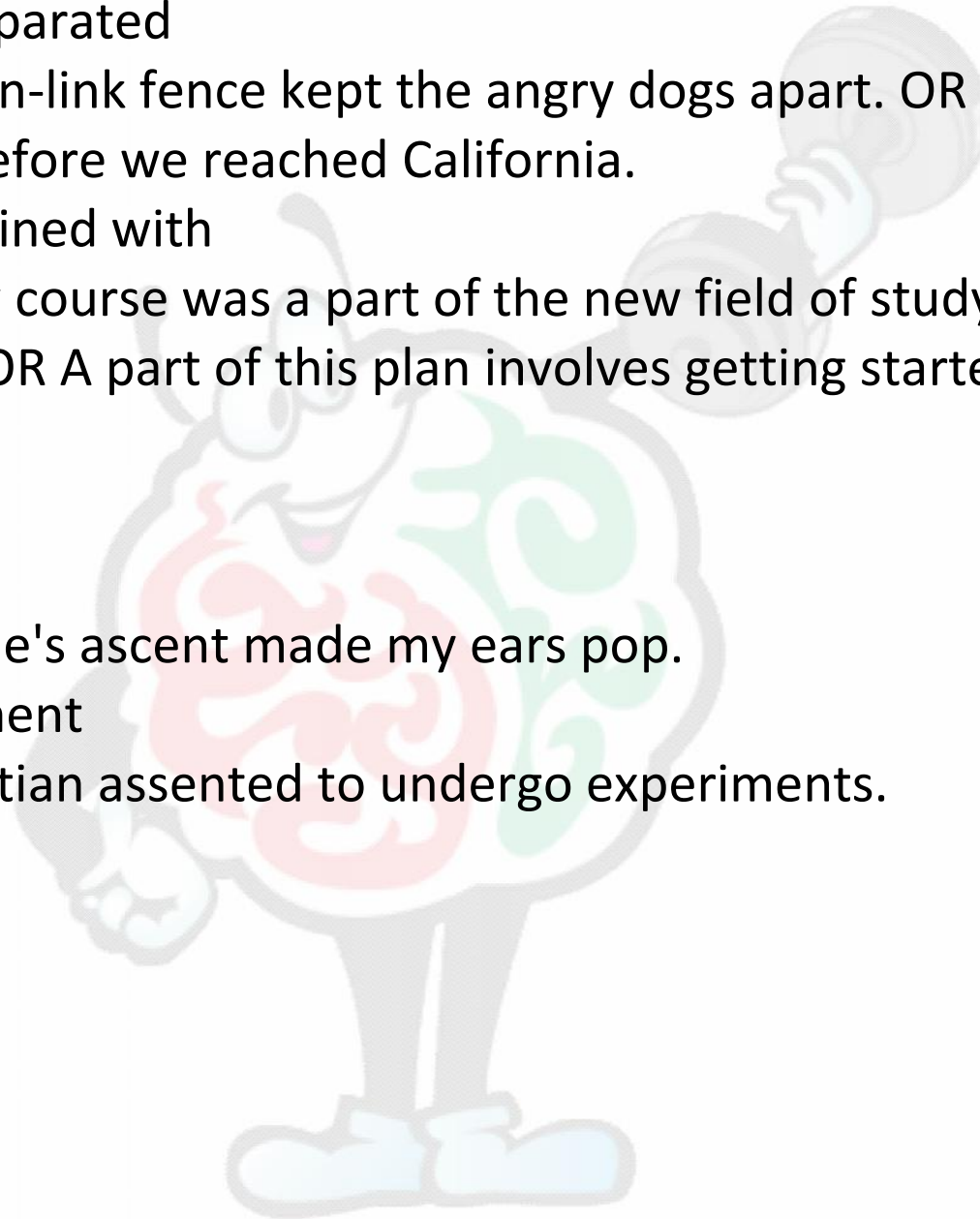
ex: The new course was a part of the new field of study at the university. OR A part of this plan involves getting started at dawn.

ASCENT- climb

ex: The plane's ascent made my ears pop.

ASSENT-agreement

ex: The martian assented to undergo experiments.



BREATH-noun, air inhaled or exhaled

ex: You could see his breath in the cold air.

BREATHE-verb, to inhale or exhale

ex: If you don't breathe, then you are dead.

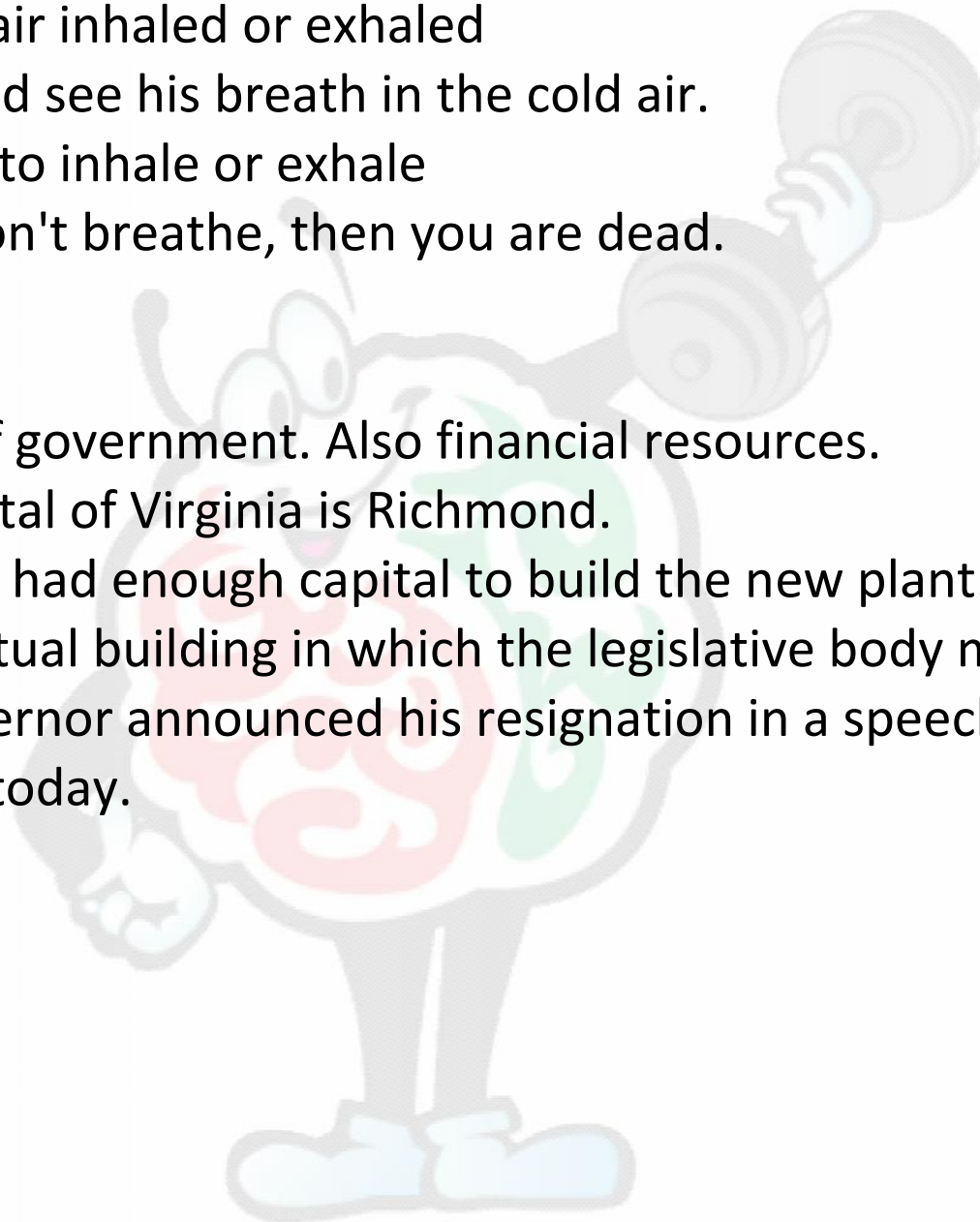
CAPITAL-seat of government. Also financial resources.

ex: The capital of Virginia is Richmond.

ex: The firm had enough capital to build the new plant.

CAPITOL-the actual building in which the legislative body meets

ex: The governor announced his resignation in a speech given at the capitol today.



CITE-to quote or document

ex: I cited ten quotes from the same author in my paper.

SIGHT-vision

ex: The sight of the American flag arouses different emotions in different parts of the world.

SITE-position or place

ex: The new office building was built on the site of a cemetery.

COMPLEMENT-noun, something that completes; verb, to complete

ex: A nice dry white wine complements a seafood entree.

COMPLIMENT-noun, praise; verb, to praise

ex: The professor complimented Betty on her proper use of a comma.

CONSCIENCE-sense of right and wrong

ex: The student's conscience kept him from cheating on the exam.

CONSCIOUS-awake

ex: I was conscious when the burglar entered the house.

COUNCIL-a group that consults or advises

ex: The men and women on the council voted in favor of an outdoor concert in their town.

COUNSEL-to advise

ex: The parole officer counseled the convict before he was released.

ELICIT-to draw or bring out

ex: The teacher elicited the correct response from the student.

ILLICIT-illegal

ex: The Columbian drug lord was arrested for his illicit activities.

EMINENT-famous, respected

ex: The eminent podiatrist won the Physician of the Year award.

IMMANENT-inherent or intrinsic

ex: The meaning of the poem was immanent, and not easily recognized.

IMMINENT-ready to take place

ex: A fight between my sister and me is imminent from the moment I enter my house.

ITS-of or belonging to it

ex: The baby will scream as soon as its mother walks out of the room.

IT'S-contraction for it is

ex: It's a beautiful day in the neighborhood.

LEAD-noun, a type of metal

ex: Is that pipe made of lead?

LED-verb, past tense of the verb "to lead"

ex: She led the campers on an over-night hike.

LIE-to lie down (a person or animal. hint: people can tell lies)

ex: I have a headache, so I'm going to lie down for a while.

(also lying, lay, has/have lain--The dog has lain in the shade all day; yesterday, the dog lay there for twelve hours).

LAY-to lay an object down.

ex: "Lay down that shotgun, Pappy!" The sheriff demanded of the crazed moonshiner.

ex: The town lay at the foot of the mountain.

(also laying, laid, has/have laid--At that point, Pappy laid the shotgun on the ground).

LOSE--verb, to misplace or not win

ex: Mom glared at Mikey. "If you lose that new lunchbox, don't even think of coming home!"

LOOSE--adjective, to not be tight; verb (rarely used)--to release

ex: The burglar's pants were so loose that he was sure to lose the race with the cop chasing him.

ex: While awaiting trial, he was never set loose from jail because no one would post his bail.

NOVEL--noun, a book that is a work of fiction. Do not use "novel" for nonfiction; use "book" or "work."

ex: Mark Twain wrote his novel *Adventures of Huckleberry Finn* when he was already well known, but before he published many other works of fiction and nonfiction.

PASSED-verb, past tense of "to pass," to have moved

ex: The tornado passed through the city quickly, but it caused great damage.

PAST-belonging to a former time or place

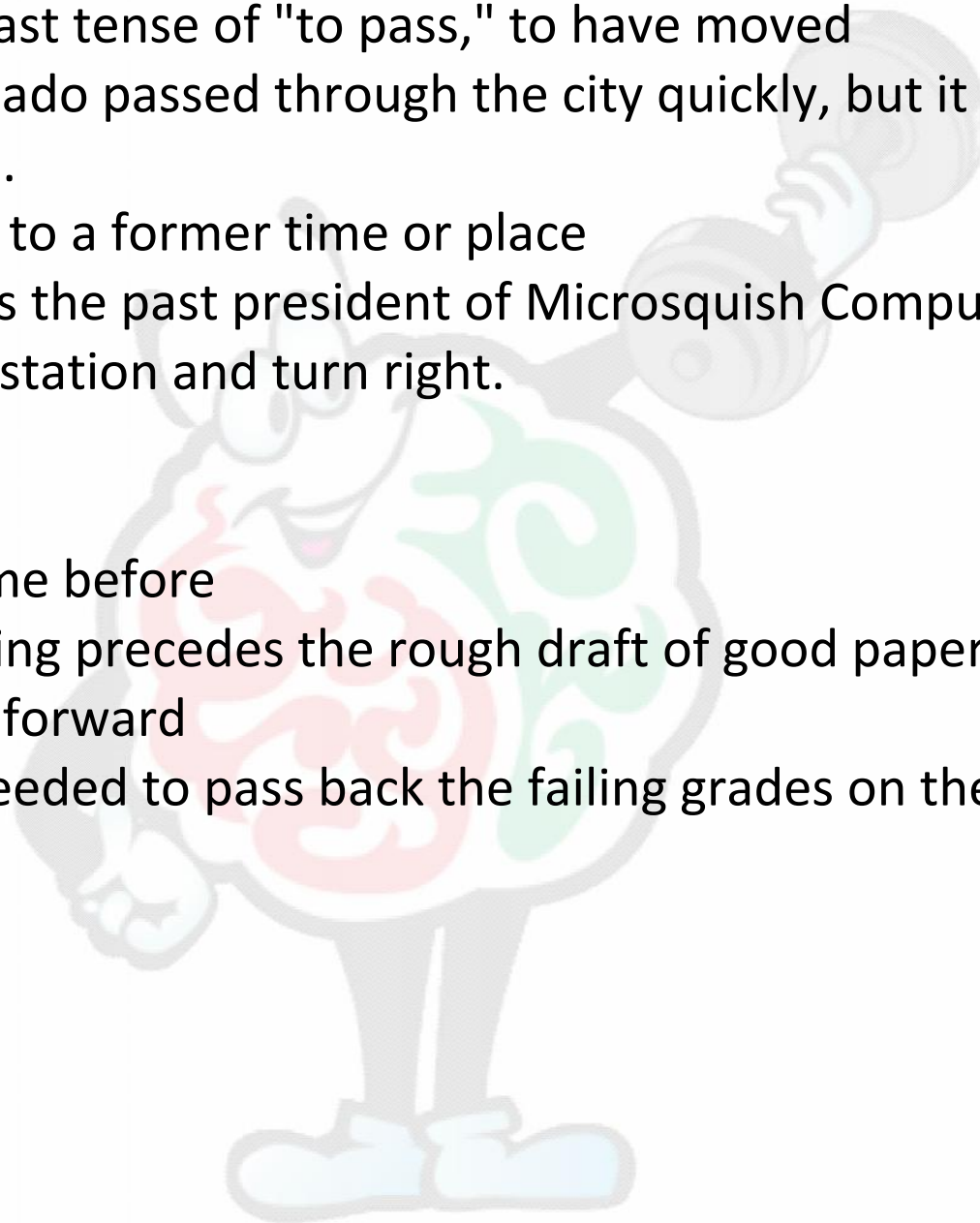
ex: Who was the past president of Microsquish Computers?; Go past the fire station and turn right.

PRECEDE-to come before

ex: Pre-writing precedes the rough draft of good papers.

PROCEED-to go forward

ex: He proceeded to pass back the failing grades on the exam.



PRINCIPAL-adjective, most important; noun, a person who has authority

ex: The principal ingredient in chocolate chip cookies is chocolate chips.

ex: The principal of the school does the announcements each morning.

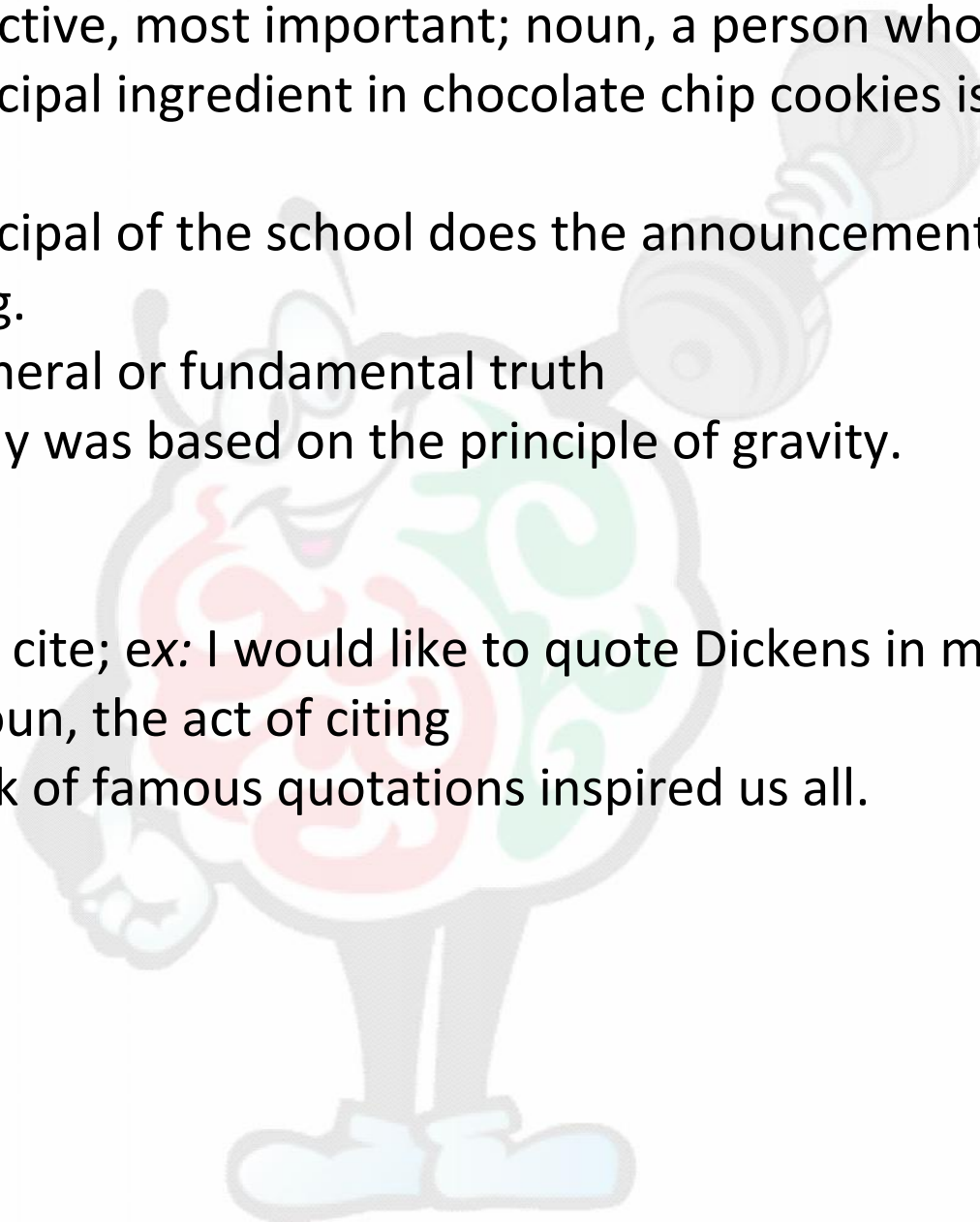
PRINCIPLE-a general or fundamental truth

ex: The study was based on the principle of gravity.

QUOTE-verb, to cite; ex: I would like to quote Dickens in my next paper.

QUOTATION-noun, the act of citing

ex: The book of famous quotations inspired us all.



STATIONARY-standing still

ex: The accident was my fault because I ran into a stationary object.

STATIONERY-writing paper

ex: My mother bought me stationery that was on recycled paper.

SUPPOSED TO-correct form for "to be obligated to" or "presumed to"
NOT "suppose to"

SUPPOSE-to guess or make a conjecture

ex: Do you suppose we will get to the airport on time? When is our plane supposed to arrive? We are supposed to check our bags before we board, but I suppose we could do that at the curb and save time.

THAN-use with comparisons

ex: I would rather go out to eat than eat at the dining hall.

THEN-at that time, or next

ex: I studied for my exam for seven hours, and then I went to bed.

THEIR-possessive form of they

ex: Their house is at the end of the block.

THERE-indicates location (hint: think of "here and there")

ex: There goes my chance of winning the lottery!

THEY'RE-contraction for "they are"

ex: They're in Europe for the summer--again!

THROUGH-by means of; finished; into or out of

ex: He plowed right through the other team's defensive line.

THREW-past tense of throw

ex: She threw away his love love letters.

THOROUGH-careful or complete

ex: John thoroughly cleaned his room; there was not even a speck of dust when he finished.

THOUGH-however; nevertheless

ex: He's really a sweetheart though he looks tough on the outside.

THRU-abbreviated slang for through; not appropriate in standard writing

ex: We're thru for the day!

TO-toward

ex: I went to the University of Richmond.

TOO-also, or excessively

ex: He drank too many screwdrivers and was unable to drive home.

TWO-a number

ex: Only two students did not turn in the assignment.

WHO-pronoun, referring to a person or persons

ex: Jane wondered how Jack, who is so smart, could be having difficulties in Calculus.

WHICH-pronoun, replacing a singular or plural thing(s); not used to refer to persons

ex: Which section of history did you get into?

THAT-used to refer to things or a group or class of people

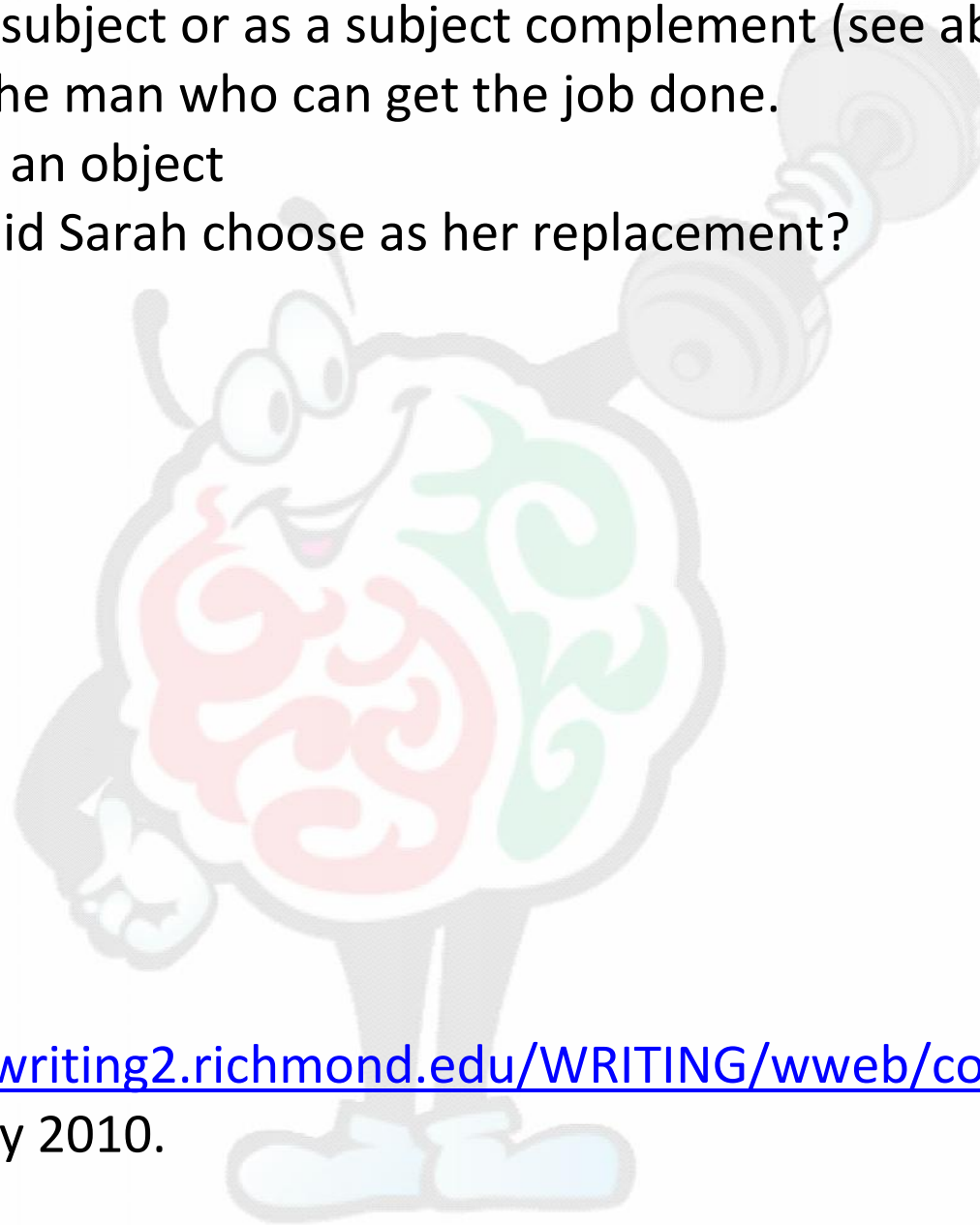
ex: I lost the book that I bought last week.

WHO-used as a subject or as a subject complement (see above)

ex: John is the man who can get the job done.

WHOM-used as an object

ex: Whom did Sarah choose as her replacement?



Source: <http://writing2.richmond.edu/WRITING/wwweb/conford.html>.

Retrieved 18 July 2010.